

Konstantin Wandel

Doctoral Researcher in Sociology | Computational Social Science

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Research interests Computational social science; multimodal measurement and video as data; measurement validity and annotation design; the German regional press; regional inequality and SOEP panel analysis; political language in parliamentary corpora

POSITIONS

- since 12/2025 **Research Fellow (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter, predoctoral)**
Social Data Science group (Prof. Dr. Simon Kühne), Faculty of Sociology, Bielefeld University; Leibniz ScienceCampus SOEP-RegioHub, phase 2
Dissertation research; development and operation of the GeoLAB research-data tools.
- 10/2024 – 04/2025 **Research Assistant**
RITZ Regional Innovation and Technology Transfer Centre GmbH
Machine-learning projects for the automotive industry; a local LLM with retrieval-augmented generation for implementing EU regulation in SMEs.
- 09/2023 – 09/2024 **Student Research Assistant**
Center for Political Communication, Zeppelin University
Causal-inference model of how wording in EU legislative texts relates to their adoption.

EDUCATION

- since 09/2026 **PhD in Sociology**
Bielefeld Graduate School in History and Sociology (BGHS), Bielefeld University
Short-Form Video as Data for the Social Sciences: Validated Multimodal Measurement of Online Communication (working title). Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Simon Kühne. Cumulative, four papers: a modality ablation on everyday short-form video; a typology and reporting standard for multimodal coding (with S. Kühne); model choice and annotation budgets under design-based supervised learning; a political stress test on PoliTok-DE.
- 09/2023 – 09/2024 **M.A. Politics, Administration & International Relations (grade 1.2)**
Zeppelin University, Friedrichshafen
Focus: natural language processing, international relations. Thesis: *Epistemicide by Bot: How Generative Media Erodes Consensus Reality*.
- 09/2018 – 03/2023 **B.A. Sociology, Politics and Economics**
Zeppelin University, Friedrichshafen
Thesis: *Politische Partizipation in der Parteiendemokratie: Krise und Chancen entlang des General Incentives Model* (online survey of highly engaged Green Party members).

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

- [1] Kühne, S., Ostermann, K., & Wandel, K. Eating together, eating alike: Household transmission and persistence of plant-based diets in Germany. *Working paper*.
- [2] Zeng, C., Gawenda, L., & Wandel, K. Who speaks for the left-behind? Framing of spatial inequalities in the House of Commons (1988–2019).
- [3] Wandel, K. Where the news is made: The vertical division of editorial labour and the distribution of originality in the German regional press.
- [4] Wandel, K. A public sphere blind to its cleavages: Ownership, size, and the geography of content sharing in the German regional press.
- [5] Wandel, K. Which constructs live in which modality? A pre-registered modality- and frame-budget ablation for validated multimodal measurement of political short-form video. *Dissertation paper*.

ONGOING COLLABORATIVE PROJECTS

Semantic drift in parliamentary speech
With L. Gawenda
Bundestag speeches 1949–2025 (GermaParl), Jina v4 embeddings, BERTopic.

RESEARCH SOFTWARE AND DATA

2026	Nguyen, H. L., Tsolak, D., & Wandel, K. <i>badata: Regional Job Market Data from the German Federal Employment Agency</i> (R package, v0.2.0). Unemployment, employment and vacancies by district and occupational group, 2012–2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.7636114
2026	Wandel, K. <i>GeoDB</i> : semantic search over the descriptions of German georeferenced data, more than 11,000 records from over 35 sources, each linked to the portal that holds the data. geodb.geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21134145
2026	Wandel, K. <i>SOEP Variable Finder</i> : multilingual semantic search over 125,496 variables of the official SOEP-Core v41 metadata. soep-faiss.geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21134306
2026	Wandel, K. <i>Parliamentary Speech Finder</i> : semantic search over 1,021,006 Bundestag speeches, 1949–2025 (GermaParl). germaparl.geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de, doi:10.5281/zenodo.21194707

TALKS AND CONFERENCES

10/2026	Video, images and text as data: Navigating a new frontier <i>LSC Research Retreat, Leibniz ScienceCampus SOEP-RegioHub, Bielefeld, 6–7 October 2026</i> Upcoming.
04/2026	Who speaks for the left-behind? Framing of spatial inequalities in the House of Commons (1988–2019) <i>Beyond the Divide: ECR Conference on the Political Dimensions of Place-Based Inequalities in Urban and Rural Life, London School of Economics, 23–24 April 2026</i> With C. Zeng and L. Gawenda; presented by L. Gawenda.
04/2026	The return of geography? Comparing the politicisation of space in the British Parliament and the German Bundestag since WWII <i>GermaParl-Workshop 2026, NRW School of Governance, University of Duisburg-Essen, 16–17 April 2026</i> With L. Gawenda.
05/2026	DACH Conference on Computational Social Science (DACH-CSS) <i>Central European University and Complexity Science Hub, Vienna, 21–22 May 2026</i> Attended.

RESEARCH INFRASTRUCTURE AND SERVICE

since 2026	GeoLAB, SOEP-RegioHub Rebuilt the project website (geolab.soz.uni-bielefeld.de); develops and maintains the three search tools above; prepared a licensed corpus of 62.7 million regional newspaper articles (2013–2024) for research use, with near-duplicate tiers and semantic search.
2026	Collaboration and advising Codebook, annotation app and calibration rounds for two student coders; methods and data advice for an MA thesis on the deservingness of the unemployed in Bundestag debates; independent check of a House of Commons speech corpus, 1919–2026 (47,651 rows), for a collaborator at King’s College London.

METHODS AND SKILLS

Methods	Panel data analysis (fixed effects, Mundlak/CRE, event studies, RI-CLPM), survey data and weighting, gravity and network models, measurement validation and inter-coder reliability, text as data (embeddings, topic models, near-duplicate detection), multimodal annotation with vision-language models
Software	R (fixest, survey, lavaan, modelsummary), Python (sentence-transformers, BERTopic, FAISS, vLLM), SQL (DuckDB), $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git, Linux
Languages	German (native), English (C2)

REFERENCES

Available on request.